

for the long term.

When it comes to coaching the USA cricket team, it's akin to managing a mini-United Nations, with players hailing from diverse linguistic and cultural backgrounds. How do you bridge these differences and ensure effective communication on the field?

I have had a pretty good upbringing in coaching, having spent time in predominantly non-English-speaking countries like Sri Lanka and Bangladesh. But one thing that is synonymous with it is the language of cricket. The cricket terms are generally the same. You might not understand everything that's being said, but if they're talking cricket, I can sort of pick up what's going on. I mean, talking to the players here, they're very respectful of the flag that they represent now. Even if they weren't born here or haven't been here that long, they're still very respectful of representing the US people. And I think that's a great thing. We stand there. We listen to it. We will be singing it, but we listen to the national anthem before the matches. It will be a proud moment for the boys. We want to provide the USA with something to be proud of. And if that happens, I'm sure the boys will be jumping out of their skins. Once we start talking cricket, the language is pretty simple. Right?

Is Stuart Law, the coach, a strict disciplinarian, or is he a friendly guy?

I probably did come in too hard at times. I've learned along the way that you've got to change. We've got to ensure that, as coaches, we're continually changing, seeking different ways to get a message across. And right now, I still expect players to turn up and do their work. And if they're not doing their work, the conversation needs to be had. And the one thing that probably has gotten me into trouble a lot is that I tell the truth, and the truth from my point of view. Not from everybody's point of view, but from what I've seen and what I think will make you a



Donning multiple hats: Stuart Law has also been the Australian team's batting coach, worked at CA's Centre of Excellence, and coached the Under-19 team.^{AFP}

better person, a better sportsman, and a better professional. At the moment, I am very friendly. I don't want you to play the way I want you to play. I want you to play the way you want to play, and I'll be here to support you and help you achieve what you want to do. And I think that's the only way you can survive. It's not the only way you can survive, but I think it's a way to survive for a while. And if it's not working, well, then you need to sit down and have that honest conversation with the player. I don't expect perfection. Cricket is the worst game for perfection. You'll never be perfect at cricket, but I expect 100% effort and dedication to the cause. The team always comes first.

Regarding the strengths and weaknesses of the USA men's cricket team, can you enumerate a couple of strengths and weaknesses?

Our batting lineup is looking pretty solid, with Steven Taylor — one of the best Associate players — and Corey Anderson on board. They bring a ton of experience, especially Corey, who's proven himself in World Cups. Having him around is a huge boost for the

younger players and those stepping up to this level for the first time.

We've got a variety of spin options. Fast bowling is only going to get better. I haven't seen Ali Khan up close in a match, but I've seen him at practice. I'm told he is very exciting. So, you know what? I don't think we will be the easy-beats that some people think we might be. I think there will be a few times when our team puts a few people on notice. And, hopefully, we might be able to pinch a win against one of the big teams. That'd be awesome. The good thing about Twenty20 cricket is that whoever turns up on the day — you know if someone has a bad day and we have a good day — you just never know. It just could be that opportunity that we're looking for, and hopefully, we're good enough to grab hold of that opportunity.

Now that we are playing in Dallas, Fort Lauderdale, and New York, all venues in the USA, of course, do you think the team will have a home-court advantage playing in front of their crowds?

I think they will be packed. The games in Dallas have been sold out for quite some time. And we play